

THE FIRST BOKE OF

Moses, called * Genesis.

THE ARGUMENT.

MOSESES in effect declareth the things, which are here chiefly to be considered: First, that the worlde & all things therein were created by God, & that man being placed in this great tabernacle of the worlde to beholde Gods wonderful workes, & to praise his Name for the infinite graces, wherewith he had endued him, fel willingly from God through disobedience: who yet for his owne mercies sake restored him to life, & confirmed him in the same by his promes of Christ to come, by whome he shulde overcome Satan, death and hel. Secondely, that the wicked, vnmindful of Gods moste excellent benefites, remained stil in their wickednes, & so falling moste horribly from sinne to sinne, prouoked God (who by his preachers called them continually to repentance) at length to destroye the whole worlde. Thirdly, he assureth vs by the exampls of Abraham, Isaac, Iacob & the rest of the Patriarkes, that his mercies neuer faile them; whome he chuseth to be his Church, and to professe his Name in earth, but in all their afflictions and persecutions he euer assisteth them, sendeth comforte, & deliuereth them. And because the beginning, increase, preseruacion and successe thereof might be onely attributed to God, Moses sheweth by the examples of Cain, Ishmael, Esau and others, which were noble in mans iudgement, that this Church dependeth not on the estimation and nobilitie of the worlde: and also by the fewenes of them, which haue at all times worshipped him purely according to his worde, that it standeth not in the multitude, but in the poore and despised, in the smale flocke and litle number, that man in his wisdom might be confounded, & the Name of God euer more praised.

CHAP. I.

1 God created the heauen & the earth, 2 The light & the darkenes, 3 The firmament. 4 He separateth the water from the earth 5 He createth the sunne, the moone, & the starres. 6 He createth the fish, birdes, beastes. 7 He createth man and giueth him rule ouer all creatures, 8 And prouideth nouriture for man and beast.



IN THE beginning * God created y heauen and the earth. And the earth was without forme & voyde, and darkenes was vpon the depe, & the Spirit of God moued

vpon the waters. 2 Then God said, * Let there be light: and there was light. 3 And God sawe y light that it was good, and God separated the light from the darkenes. 4 And God called the light, Day, and the darkenes, he called Night. || So the euenig and the morning were the first day. 5 ¶ Againe God said, * Let there be a firmament in the middes of the waters: and let it separate the waters from the waters. 6 Then God made the firmament, & parted the waters, which were vnder the firmament, from the waters which were above the firmament, and it was so. 7 And God called the firmament, Heauen. || So the euenig and the morning were the seconde day. 8 ¶ God said againe, * Let the waters vnder the heauē be gathered into one place, & let the drye land appeare, and it was so. 9 And God called the drye land, Earth, & he called y gathering together of the waters, Seas: & God sawe that it was good. 10 Then God said, * Let the earth budde

forthe the budde of the herbe, that sedeth sede, the fruteful tre, w beareth frute according to his kinde, which maie haue his sede in it self vpon the earth. & it was so. 11 And the earth broght forth the budde of the herbe, that sedeth sede accordig to his kinde, also the tre that yeldeth frute, w hathe his sede in it selfe according to his kinde: & God sawe that it was good. 12 || So the euenig and the morning were the third daie. 13 ¶ And God said, * Let there be lightes in the firmament of the heauen, to separate the daie from the night, & let them be for signes, and for seasons, and for daies and yeres. 14 And let them be for lightes in the firmament of the heauen to giue light vpon the earth, and it was so. 15 God then made two great lightes: the greater light to rule the daie, & the lesse light to rule y night: he made also y starres. 16 And God set them in the firmament of the heauen, to shine vpon the earth, 17 And to rule in the daie, & in the night, and to separate the light from the darkenes: and God sawe that it was good. 18 || So the euenig and the morning were the fourth daie. 19 Afterwarde God said, Let the waters bring forth in abundāce euerie creeping thing that hath life: & let the soule flie vpon the earth in the open firmament of the heauen. 20 Then God created the great whales, & euerie thing liuing & mouing, w the waters broght forth in abundāce, accordig to their kinde, & euerie feathered soule according to his kinde: & God sawe that it was good.

* This worde signifieth the beginning and generation of the creature.

i This sentence is so oft repeated, to signifye y God made all his creatures to serue to his glorie, & to the profit of man: but for sinne they were accursed, yet to y elect, by Christ they are restored & serue to their welth.

|| The 3. day.

¶ Psal. 136. 7.

dent. 4. 19.

k By y lightes he meaneth y sunne, the moone, and the starres.

l Which is y artificiall day, fro the sunne rising to the going downe.

m Of things appertaining to natural and political ordres and seasons.

n To wit, the sunne and the moone: & here he speaketh as man iudgeth by his eye: for els the moone is lesse the the planete Saturnus.

o To giue it sufficient light, as instruments appointed for y same, to serue to man vfe.

¶ Ier. 31. 35.

|| The 4. day.

p As fish and wormes which slide, swimme or crepe.

¶ Ebr. the soule if life.

¶ Ebr. face of the firmament.

q The fish & foules, had bothe one beginning, wherco we see that nature giueth place to Gods wil, forasmuch as the one sorte is made to flie aboute in the ayre, & the other to swimme beneath in the water.